

MODERN INVENTIONS

East Asia has led the world in developing new electronic goods, such as digital cameras, video games, and personal stereos. In recent years, the region has also developed robotics, maglev trains (which run on magnets), and 3D-printed electric cars such as the LSEV.



ASIMO



DIGITAL CAMERA

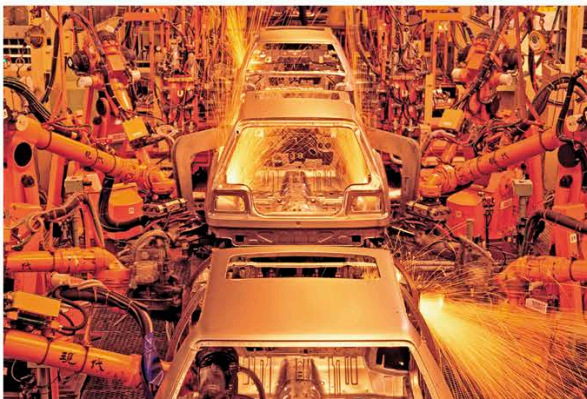
A knee joint helps ASIMO run like a human.



LSEV

▼ SOUTH KOREA

In 1961, South Korea closed its borders to all imports except raw materials and began to promote its own conglomerates (big companies made up of lots of different businesses), such as Hyundai and Samsung. These produced cars, electronics, and other goods for export. As a result, the economy is now one of the largest in the world.



MODERNIZATION OF CHINA ►

When Chinese leader Deng Xiaoping came to power in 1978, he introduced massive economic reforms. Farmers were allowed to work their land for profit and entrepreneurs were encouraged to start new businesses. In 1985, the government also stopped setting the prices for goods. Many old cities such as Shanghai (right) were transformed. In 2010, China overtook Japan as the world's second largest economy, and is on track to overtake the US, the world's biggest, by 2026.

